Weak Two-bids
Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)
Raise of Opener's suit is to play.
Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.
After 2NT Response, Opener bids:
  3 of original suit to show a weak hand
  3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit
  3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids
An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.
As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠A

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣6

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 3
♥ 2
♦ 7 5 4
♣ J 5

♠ 6 4
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ A K J 10 8
♣ Q 6



♠ A
♥ K Q 6
♦ Q 9 6 2
♣ 10 8 7 4 3

♠ 10 9 2
♥ A 8 7 4 3
♦ 3
♣ A K 9 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH assumes her partner can win six tricks. So she will need to contribute four more to make game.

Three of them are obvious, and she expects to get a ♦ ruff also.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 3 ♥ A Q 10 6 ♦ K J 10 7 ♣ 10 9 3	
♠ Q 9 ♥ J 7 5 ♦ A 9 6 ♣ A Q J 4 2	N W E S	♠ A K 8 7 6 2 ♥ 8 3 ♦ 8 3 ♣ K 6 5
	♠ J 5 4 ♥ K 9 4 2 ♦ Q 5 4 2 ♣ 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦4

EAST's hand has the look of a Weak Two-bid, but it is one point too strong. So she opens 1♠.

WEST naturally bids 2♣ and EAST rebids the ♠ suit.

WEST always knew there would be a game bid, so with an 8-card fit he bids 4♠

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 8 3
♥ 10 6
♦ K J 4
♣ K Q J 4

♠ A K 9
♥ 9 4
♦ A 10 8 6
♣ 9 6 3 2



♠ 10 7 4 2
♥ K 2
♦ Q 3 2
♣ A 10 8 7

♠ 6 5
♥ A Q J 8 7 5 3
♦ 9 7 5
♣ 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			3♥
All Pass			

3♥ by South
Lead: ♠A

NORTH may have an opening hand, but it is just the wrong kind of hand to respond to partner's preemptive bid. She doesn't have the immediate winners that SOUTH is likely to need, but she is in good shape for defense should the opponents bid.

In other words, NORTH has the perfect hand with which to pass.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ A 6
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ 10 5
♣ Q 10 7 6 3

♠ K Q J
♥ A K 7
♦ J 6 3
♣ A K 4 2



♠ 5 4
♥ 8 6 3
♦ A K Q 9 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ 10 9 8 7 3 2
♥ J 5 4
♦ 8 2
♣ J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♣6

The 2NT response to a Weak Two opening is a wonderful tool. You can learn a lot about partner's hand and you are absolutely certain that it will not be passed out.

In this Deal WEST has a huge hand and EAST opens 2♦. There are a lot of approaches WEST might try, but the simplest is to start with 2NT.

When EAST shows ♦ A K Q x x x WEST has an easy 6NT bid.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9 7 5 2
♥ K 3
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 7 3

♠ 8 3
♥ 9 7 6
♦ A K 10 7
♣ K Q 10 2



♠ 10 4
♥ 10 8 5
♦ Q J 3
♣ J 9 8 6 4

♠ K J 6
♥ A Q J 4 2
♦ 9 6 4
♣ A 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

SOUTH is unsure whether to bid game or not. So she temporizes with 2NT.

NORTH shows an above average hand plus a high card in ♥s.

SOUTH is no longer unsure, so she bids 4♠.